LARKSPUR & CO.

LIFE ADMIN & LEGACY PLANNER · UK

The Just in Case Binder

Everything your people would need to know, kept safely in one place.

Printable | Fillable PDF | UK nations | Spreadsheet included



A planning and record-keeping tool. It isn't legal, financial or medical advice and it doesn't replace a will or power of attorney.

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START HERE

A gift to the people you love

If you were suddenly ill, in hospital or gone, could someone find your bank, your pension, your will and your pet's vet? Most families can't. They spend months searching through drawers, inboxes and statements while they're grieving.

This binder fixes that. Work through it slowly, a section at a time. You don't need to finish it in one go and you don't need to fill in every page: skip anything that doesn't apply to you.

HOW TO USE IT

- [ ] Print it, or type straight into the fillable PDF
- [ ] Do one section a week (about 20 minutes each)
- [ ] Write **where** things are, not secret codes
- [ ] Tell one or two trusted people where it's kept
- [ ] Review it once a year, and after big life changes
- [ ] Use the spreadsheet for accounts and bills that change often

KEEP IT SAFE

- [ ] **Never write passwords, PINs or full card numbers here.** Use a password manager with emergency access instead
- [ ] Only write the last 4 digits of account numbers
- [ ] Store it somewhere secure but findable: a locked drawer or fire safe
- [ ] Keep the fillable PDF on an encrypted device, not in an email

Across the UK. Wills, powers of attorney and estates work differently in England & Wales, Scotland and Northern Ireland. Where it matters, the page tells you. This binder is a record-keeping tool, not legal advice: a solicitor can check your will and attorney documents are valid.

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Also included: **Life Admin Register.xlsx**, a spreadsheet for the details that change often (accounts, bills, renewals). It works in Excel, Google Sheets and Numbers.

BEFORE YOU START

Where this binder lives

The most organised binder in the world is no use if nobody can find it.

THIS BINDER IS KEPT

Location _____

Spare copy _____

Digital copy (where) _____

Key / access held by _____

PEOPLE WHO KNOW WHERE IT IS

Name _____

Name _____

Name _____

Name _____

MY IMPORTANT PEOPLE SHOULD CALL FIRST

Name & phone _____

Name & phone _____

My solicitor (if I have one) _____

LAST FULLY REVIEWED

DATE	WHAT I UPDATED	NEXT REVIEW

NOTES

SECTION 1

About me

The basic details people are asked for again and again, from the GP surgery to the registrar.

- [ ] Personal details
- [ ] Family and key people
- [ ] Important contacts

NOTES

ABOUT ME

Personal details

The registrar, banks and pension providers will ask for these.

ME

Full legal name _____

Other names used _____

Date of birth _____

Place of birth _____

Home address _____

Postcode _____

NUMBERS (WRITE WHERE TO FIND THEM)

National Insurance number _____

NHS / CHI / H&C number _____

Passport (where kept) _____

Driving licence (where kept) _____

Tax reference (UTR) if any _____

Blood group (if known) _____

RELATIONSHIPS

Marital / civil partnership status _____

Spouse / partner _____

Date of marriage / partnership _____

Previous marriages _____

WORK

Employer or business _____

Job title _____

HR / payroll contact _____

Retired? Date _____

NOTES

ABOUT ME

Family & key people

The people closest to you, and who should be told first.

NAME	RELATIONSHIP	PHONE	ADDRESS / EMAIL	TELL FIRST?

NOTES

ABOUT ME

Important contacts

Professionals and helpers who know your affairs.

WHO	NAME / FIRM	PHONE	EMAIL / REFERENCE
GP surgery			
Solicitor			
Accountant			
Financial adviser			
Executor(s)			
Attorney(s)			
Employer / HR			
Faith leader / celebrant			
Neighbour with a key			
Landlord / letting agent			
Carer / care agency			

NOTES

SECTION 2

Legal documents

Your will and powers of attorney decide who looks after your affairs. These pages record what exists and where the originals are kept.

- [ ] My will
- [ ] Power of attorney
- [ ] Where my documents are

NOTES

LEGAL

My will

Record the details here. Keep the signed original somewhere safe: a copy is not usually enough.

ABOUT MY WILL

I have a will ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure

Date signed _____

Original kept at _____

Copy kept at _____

Prepared by _____

Registered (e.g. Certainty) ref _____

PEOPLE NAMED IN IT

Executor 1 _____

Executor 2 _____

Guardian(s) for children _____

Trustees (if any) _____

Letter of wishes ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure

Good to know across the UK. In England, Wales and Northern Ireland, getting married or entering a civil partnership usually cancels an existing will, so you'd need a new one. This doesn't happen in Scotland. Scotland also gives a spouse, civil partner and children "legal rights" to part of the estate whatever the will says. If your life has changed since you made your will, ask a solicitor to check it.

CHANGES I WANT TO MAKE / QUESTIONS FOR MY SOLICITOR

LEGAL

Power of attorney

A power of attorney lets someone you trust make decisions if you can't. It only works if it's made while you can still decide for yourself.

ENGLAND & WALES

Lasting Power of Attorney (LPA). Two types: **property & financial affairs**, and **health & welfare**. Registered with the Office of the Public Guardian.

SCOTLAND

Continuing (money and property) and **welfare** powers of attorney, often in one document. Registered with the Office of the Public Guardian (Scotland).

NORTHERN IRELAND

Usually an **Enduring Power of Attorney** for money and property, registered with the Office of Care and Protection when needed. The law is changing: check nidirect for current rules.

TYPE	ATTORNEY(S)	DATE MADE	REGISTERED?	ORIGINAL KEPT
Money & property				
Health & welfare				
Other				

WHO HAS A COPY

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

NOTES FOR MY ATTORNEYS

LEGAL

Where my documents are

One look at this page should tell anyone where to find each original.

DOCUMENT	WHERE IT'S KEPT	NOTES
Birth certificate		
Marriage / civil partnership certificate		
Divorce / dissolution papers		
Passport		
Driving licence		
Will and letter of wishes		
Power of attorney		
Property deeds / tenancy agreement		
Mortgage papers		
Pension statements		
Insurance policies		
Funeral plan		
Vehicle log book (V5C)		
Recent tax returns / P60s		
Medical letters		

NOTES

SECTION 3

Health & care

If you're taken ill, the people with you will be asked about your health, medication and wishes. Help them answer.

- [ ] My health
- [ ] Medication
- [ ] Care wishes
- [ ] Organ and body donation
- [ ] If I'm in hospital

NOTES

HEALTH

My health

Keep this up to date, or note where an up-to-date list is kept.

MEDICAL BASICS

GP surgery _____

GP phone _____

NHS / CHI / H&C no. (where) _____

Blood group _____

Allergies _____

Organ donor decision recorded? _____

SPECIALISTS & SERVICES

Consultant / hospital _____

Consultant / hospital _____

Pharmacy _____

Dentist _____

Optician _____

CONDITIONS & IMPORTANT HISTORY

MEDICATION

MEDICINE	DOSE	WHEN	WHAT FOR

HEALTH

My care wishes

What matters to you if you become seriously ill. Talk these through with your GP and family, too.

DOCUMENTS I HAVE

Advance decision / directive	☐ Yes	☐ No	☐ Not sure
Advance statement of wishes	☐ Yes	☐ No	☐ Not sure
DNACPR form	☐ Yes	☐ No	☐ Not sure
ReSPECT / future care plan	☐ Yes	☐ No	☐ Not sure

Kept at _____

WHERE I'D PREFER TO BE CARED FOR

- ☐ At home
- ☐ In a hospice
- ☐ In hospital
- ☐ In a care home
- ☐ Wherever is best at the time

Other _____

Rules differ across the UK. In England and Wales an advance decision to refuse treatment can be legally binding if made correctly. In Scotland and Northern Ireland advance directives are taken into account by doctors. Your GP can help you record your wishes properly.

PEOPLE I'D LIKE WITH ME

Names _____

Faith / spiritual support _____

WHAT MATTERS MOST TO ME

THINGS I WOULD NOT WANT

HEALTH

Organ & body donation

Your decision, written down, makes things easier for your family at a very hard time.

All four UK nations now have an "opt-out" system: you are considered willing to donate unless you've recorded otherwise or are in an excluded group. Your family will still be asked, so tell them what you want. You can record or change your decision on the NHS Organ Donor Register.

MY DECISION

- ☐ I want to donate all my organs and tissue
- ☐ I want to donate some (listed below)
- ☐ I don't want to donate
- ☐ I'd like someone else to decide (named below)
- ☐ I've recorded this on the NHS Organ Donor Register

Date recorded _____

DETAILS

Organs / tissue I'm happy to donate _____

Faith or beliefs to respect _____

Person to decide for me _____

Their phone _____

BODY DONATION FOR MEDICAL SCIENCE

This must be arranged in advance with a medical school, and they may not always be able to accept. Write the details here and keep the consent form with this binder.

I've arranged body donation ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure

Medical school _____

Phone _____

Consent form kept _____

ANYTHING ELSE

HEALTH

If I'm in hospital

A quick plan so the people around you know what to do straight away.

PLEASE CALL

First _____

Then _____

My employer (if working) _____

Anyone I care for _____

PLEASE BRING

- [ ] My medication and list
- [ ] Glasses / hearing aids
- [ ] Phone and charger
- [ ] Comfortable clothes
- [ ] Toiletries
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____

AT HOME, PLEASE

- [ ] Feed and care for my pets (see pets page)
- [ ] Check the post
- [ ] Check the fridge
- [ ] Water the plants
- [ ] Lock up and set the alarm
- [ ] _____
- [ ] _____

BILLS THAT MUST NOT BE MISSED

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

OTHER THINGS TO KNOW

SECTION 4

Money

Your executors have to find every account, policy and debt. Most of the delay after a death comes from not knowing what exists. List them all here.

- [ ] Bank accounts
- [ ] Savings and investments
- [ ] Pensions
- [ ] Insurance
- [ ] Debts and credit
- [ ] Income and benefits
- [ ] Bills and direct debits
- [ ] Subscriptions

NOTES

MONEY

Bank & building society accounts

Current accounts, savings accounts, joint accounts and business accounts.

BANK	TYPE	LAST 4 DIGITS	JOINT WITH	ONLINE / APP?	NOTES

Only write the last four digits. Lost track of an old account? The free My Lost Account service (mylostaccount.org.uk) can search banks and building societies.

NOTES

MONEY

Savings & investments

ISAs, Premium Bonds, shares, funds and anything else you own.

PROVIDER	TYPE	REFERENCE (LAST 4)	APPROX. VALUE	NOTES

CRYPTOCURRENCY OR OTHER DIGITAL ASSETS

Never write keys or recovery phrases here. Write which exchange or wallet you use and where your recovery information is securely stored.

Exchange / wallet _____

Recovery information kept _____

NOTES

MONEY

Pensions

Include every old workplace pension too. People often have several.

PROVIDER / EMPLOYER	TYPE	POLICY REF (LAST 4)	NOMINATION FORM DONE?	NOTES

STATE PENSION

Receiving? Since _____

Forecast checked (date) _____

GOOD TO KNOW

Fill in an "expression of wish" or nomination form with each pension so the provider knows who you'd like to benefit. Lost a pension? Try the free Pension Tracing Service on GOV.UK.

NOTES

MONEY

Insurance & plans

Some of these pay out when you die or become ill, so your family must know they exist.

TYPE	PROVIDER	POLICY REF	RENEWS	NOTES
Life insurance				
Life insurance (2)				
Critical illness				
Income protection				
Mortgage protection				
Death-in-service (work)				
Funeral plan				
Buildings				
Contents				
Car				
Pet				
Travel				

Ask whether your life insurance is "written in trust". If it is, it can usually be paid to the people you chose faster and outside your estate.

NOTES

MONEY

Debts & credit

Mortgages, loans, credit cards, car finance and buy now, pay later.

LENDER	TYPE	REF (LAST 4)	APPROX. OWED	INSURED?	NOTES

Debts are normally paid from the estate, not by family members personally, unless the debt was joint or someone was a guarantor. Your executor can ask a solicitor or Citizens Advice if unsure.

NOTES

MONEY

Income & benefits

Money coming in that will need to be stopped or claimed.

WORK

Employer / business _____

Payroll contact _____

Paid into (bank) _____

Death-in-service benefit? _____

SELF-EMPLOYED

Business name _____

Accountant _____

Business bank _____

Records kept _____

BENEFITS

Benefit 1 _____

Benefit 2 _____

Benefit 3 _____

Paid into (bank) _____

OTHER INCOME

Rental income _____

Investments / dividends _____

Money owed to me _____

Other _____

NOTES

MONEY

Bills & direct debits

Household bills that will need to be cancelled, transferred or kept running.

BILL	COMPANY	ACCOUNT REF	£ / MONTH	PAID FROM
Council tax				
Mortgage / rent				
Electricity				
Gas				
Water				
Broadband				
Mobile phone				
TV Licence				
Home insurance				

NOTES

MONEY

Subscriptions & memberships

Streaming, apps, gyms, magazines, charities, clubs. Many renew automatically.

SERVICE	COST	HOW OFTEN	PAID BY (CARD / BANK)	CANCEL OR KEEP?

NOTES

SECTION 5

Home & belongings

The practical details of your home, car and the things that matter to you.

- [ ] My home
- [ ] Vehicles
- [ ] Special belongings
- [ ] Household know-how

NOTES

HOME

My home

Owned or rented, these are the details someone would need to look after it.

THE PROPERTY

- [ ] I own it (alone)
- [ ] I own it jointly
- [ ] I rent it
- [ ] I live in someone else's home

Deeds / tenancy kept _____

Mortgage lender / landlord _____

Joint owner _____

ACCESS

Spare keys held by _____

Alarm company _____

Alarm code is kept (not the code!) _____

Window keys _____

Garage / shed keys _____

WHERE THINGS ARE

Stopcock _____

Fuse box _____

Gas meter _____

Electric meter _____

Boiler & manual _____

Bin day _____

Smoke alarms _____

Spare bulbs & batteries _____

OTHER PROPERTIES (HOLIDAY HOME, LAND, RENTED OUT)

HOME

Vehicles

Cars, motorbikes, caravans and anything with a log book.

VEHICLE 1

Make & model _____

Registration _____

Log book (V5C) kept _____

Finance company _____

Insurer _____

Breakdown cover _____

MOT due _____

Spare key _____

VEHICLE 2

Make & model _____

Registration _____

Log book (V5C) kept _____

Finance company _____

Insurer _____

Breakdown cover _____

MOT due _____

Spare key _____

OTHER (CARAVAN, BIKE, BOAT, MOBILITY SCOOTER)

If a vehicle is on finance, it may belong to the finance company until it's paid off. Tell DVLA when the keeper of a vehicle dies (Tell Us Once can do this in most cases).

HOME

Special belongings

Things with financial or sentimental value, and who you'd like to have them.

ITEM	WHERE IT IS	I'D LIKE IT TO GO TO	IN MY WILL?

This page isn't legally binding. To make sure someone receives a particular item, include it in your will or a letter of wishes and ask your solicitor how to do this.

NOTES

HOME

Household know-how

The things only you know about running your home.

ROUTINES & QUIRKS

TRUSTED TRADES

Plumber

Electrician

Boiler engineer

Handyperson

Cleaner

Gardener

Window cleaner

THINGS THAT NEED DOING EACH SEASON

SPRING	SUMMER	AUTUMN	WINTER

NOTES

SECTION 6

Digital life

Phones, emails, photos and social media. Without a plan, these can be lost for good or left online forever.

- [ ] Devices and access
- [ ] Email and key accounts
- [ ] Social media wishes
- [ ] Photos and files

NOTES

DIGITAL

Devices & access

Don't write passwords or PINs here. Record how someone you trust can get access safely.

DEVICE	MAKE / MODEL	WHERE IT IS	HOW TO GET ACCESS (NO CODES)
Phone			
Laptop / computer			
Tablet			
Smart watch			

PASSWORD MANAGER

Which one _____

Emergency access set up for _____

Date set up _____

Most password managers (such as 1Password, Bitwarden, Apple Passwords or Google Password Manager) let you share access safely in an emergency.

PHONE & EMAIL ACCOUNTS

Main email _____

Other email _____

Mobile network _____

Apple ID / Google account email _____

LEGACY SETTINGS I'VE TURNED ON

- [ ] Apple Legacy Contact (Settings › your name › Sign-In & Security)
- [ ] Google Inactive Account Manager (myaccount.google.com)
- [ ] Facebook legacy contact
- [ ] Password manager emergency access

NOTES

DIGITAL

Online accounts & my wishes

Tell people what you'd like to happen to each account: keep, memorialise or close.

ACCOUNT	USERNAME / EMAIL	KEEP / MEMORIALISE / CLOSE	LEGACY CONTACT SET?	NOTES
Facebook				
Instagram				
X / Threads / TikTok				
LinkedIn				
YouTube / Google				
Amazon				
eBay / Vinted / Etsy				
PayPal				
Online shops				
Gaming / other				

PayPal and online accounts holding money or store credit should be listed in your money pages too. Websites can be domain names you own and renew each year.

NOTES

DIGITAL

Photos, files & memories

Your photos are often the thing your family will treasure most.

WHERE MY PHOTOS ARE

- [ ] iCloud Photos
- [ ] Google Photos
- [ ] On my phone only
- [ ] On my computer
- [ ] External drive / USB
- [ ] Printed albums
- [ ] Facebook / Instagram

Other _____

IMPORTANT FILES

Family history _____

Recipes _____

Videos _____

Writing / music _____

Work files _____

WHO SHOULD GET COPIES, AND ANYTHING PRIVATE THAT SHOULD BE DELETED

SECTION 7

People & pets

Anyone (or any animal) who depends on you needs a plan, right away.

- [ ] People I care for
- [ ] My pets' care plan
- [ ] People to tell

NOTES

PEOPLE

People I care for

Children, a partner, an older parent or anyone who relies on you.

PERSON 1

Name _____

Relationship _____

Needs / routines _____

School / care provider _____

Medication _____

Who should step in _____

Their phone _____

PERSON 2

Name _____

Relationship _____

Needs / routines _____

School / care provider _____

Medication _____

Who should step in _____

Their phone _____

THINGS THEY FIND COMFORTING / ROUTINES TO KEEP

PETS

My pets' care plan

Who will look after them, and everything that person needs to know.

PET 1

Name & species

Age / breed

Microchip no. / database

Vet & phone

Insurance

Food & amount

Medication

Who will take them

PET 2

Name & species

Age / breed

Microchip no. / database

Vet & phone

Insurance

Food & amount

Medication

Who will take them

ROUTINES, LIKES AND FEARS

Some UK charities offer free rehoming promises for pets whose owners die: for example Dogs Trust's Canine Care Card and Cats Protection's Cat Guardians. Check their websites for current details.

Scheme & reference

PEOPLE

People to tell

Friends, groups, clubs and colleagues who'd want to know. Your family will use this list.

NAME / GROUP	HOW THEY KNOW ME	PHONE / EMAIL	TOLD

NOTES

SECTION 8

Funeral wishes

Your family will want to get it right. Telling them what you want takes a huge weight off their shoulders.

- [ ] My funeral wishes
- [ ] Music, readings and words
- [ ] My story

NOTES

FUNERAL

My funeral wishes

Tick what you'd like. Leave anything you're happy for your family to decide.

I WOULD LIKE

- [ ] Burial
- [ ] Cremation
- [ ] Direct cremation (no service)
- [ ] Natural / woodland burial
- [ ] My family to decide

THE SERVICE

- [ ] Religious
- [ ] Non-religious / humanist
- [ ] Celebration of life
- [ ] Private, family only
- [ ] Open to everyone

AFTERWARDS

- [ ] Wake / gathering
- [ ] Ashes scattered
- [ ] Ashes kept
- [ ] Headstone / plaque
- [ ] Memorial tree

DETAILS

Funeral director _____

Venue _____

Celebrant / minister _____

Burial / scattering place _____

What people should wear _____

Flowers or donations to _____

FUNERAL PLAN

I have a prepaid funeral plan ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure

Provider _____

Plan number _____

Paperwork kept _____

What it covers _____

Funeral plan providers have been regulated by the Financial Conduct Authority since 2022.

ANYTHING ELSE ABOUT THE DAY

FUNERAL

Music, readings & words

The songs, poems and words that feel like you.

WHEN	SONG, HYMN, POEM OR READING	READ / SUNG BY
Arriving		
During the service		
During the service		
Reading		
Reading		
Leaving		
At the gathering		

PEOPLE I'D LIKE TO SPEAK

THINGS I'D LOVE PEOPLE TO REMEMBER

FUNERAL

My story

Notes for whoever writes your eulogy or obituary. A few words each is plenty.

WHERE I GREW UP

WORK I DID

PEOPLE WHO SHAPED ME

THINGS I LOVED

PROUDEST MOMENTS

FUNNY STORIES

HOW I'D LIKE TO BE REMEMBERED

SECTION 9

Letters

Sometimes the most important thing in the binder isn't a policy number. It's a few words for the people you love.

- [ ] Letters to loved ones
- [ ] Write as many as you like
- [ ] Seal them in an envelope if you prefer

NOTES

LETTERS

A letter for you

To

Date

LETTERS

A letter for you

To

Date

LETTERS

A letter for you

To

Date

KEEPING IT CURRENT

Yearly review

Pick a date you'll remember (a birthday, or the first week of January) and check the binder once a year.

REVIEW THESE EVERY YEAR

- [ ] Bank accounts and savings
- [ ] Pensions (any new ones?)
- [ ] Insurance renewals
- [ ] Bills and subscriptions
- [ ] Contacts and phone numbers
- [ ] Medication
- [ ] Digital accounts and legacy settings
- [ ] Where this binder is kept

UPDATE STRAIGHT AWAY IF

- [ ] You marry, divorce or separate
- [ ] You have a baby or a grandchild
- [ ] You move house
- [ ] You change job or retire
- [ ] Someone named in your will dies
- [ ] You get a new pet
- [ ] You're diagnosed with a serious illness

REVIEW LOG

DATE	WHAT I UPDATED	INITIALS

KEEPING IT CURRENT

Useful UK services

Free and official places to find help. Search the names to find current contact details.

GOV.UK / mygov.scot / nidirect

Official guidance on wills, powers of attorney, probate and confirmation for each nation.

Office of the Public Guardian

Lasting Power of Attorney in England and Wales. Scotland has its own Office of the Public Guardian (Scotland).

NHS Organ Donor Register

Record or change your organ donation decision online.

Pension Tracing Service

Free GOV.UK service to find contact details for old workplace and personal pensions.

My Lost Account

Free service to search for lost bank, building society and NS&I accounts.

Citizens Advice

Free, independent advice on money, debt, benefits and legal questions.

Law Society / Law Society of Scotland / Law Society of NI

Find a solicitor near you for wills and powers of attorney.

Dying Matters / Compassion in Dying

Support with talking about death and planning end of life care.

Details change. Always check official websites for current rules and costs. This binder is a record-keeping tool and doesn't give legal, financial or medical advice.

NOTES

NOTES

Notes